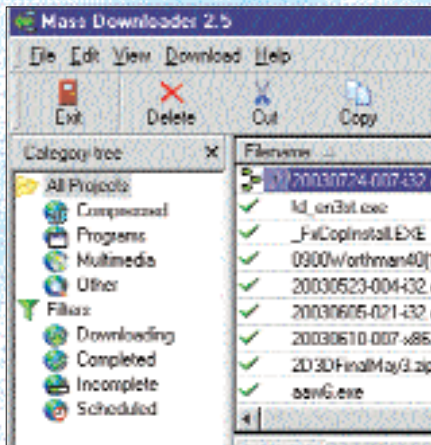




Mass downloader supports categorised downloading, so you can sort your files

archive, and download only selected files. These files then show up as a new archive. Apart from this, Mass Downloader fully supports download resuming. Different threads, from different mirror sites can be downloaded simultaneously to improve transfer speeds. The program also supports categorised downloading, which is quite useful when you

have a large number of downloads on the list, as well as a speed-limiting feature that is useful if you want to simultaneously surf the Internet. Mass Downloader integrates with most major browsers such as Internet Explorer, and manages the downloads instead of letting the browser do so. For those who regularly use File Transport Protocol (FTP) sites for download, the program has a fully featured internal FTP browser. Finally, if you have used other download managers before, the program allows you to import incomplete downloads to the program.

FlashGet 1.40 (www.amazesoft.com) is a download manager that encompasses many features to give you a great downloading experience. It's received awards from ZDNet and Webattack.com for its features. Like Mass Downloader, FlashGet also supports segmented downloading from up to 10 sources; it supports categorised downloading; the scheduling features are powerful; and it features drag-and-drop support.



Short bytes

Download Accelerator Plus 5.3 (www.speedbit.com) is probably one of the most popular download managers available today. It provides most of the useful features, and sports an intuitive interface. Choose from three types of accelerations—No Acceleration, Acceleration, Medium Acceleration and High Acceleration—while downloading to set the download speed. The only problem is the constant advertisements and lesser control over download options.

GetRight 5.0.2 (www.getright.com) allows you to download all your files safely and speedily. It is packed with features such as synchronization of downloads and cookie support, and allows for segmentation.

Though P2P networks and file-sharing programs are infamous for illegal downloads, these networks are still a great way to find files that are hard to get. Searching for files is extremely simple—all you have to do is type in the program name and the category, and you get the

Hop, Skip and Download...

Data is sent from a Web site to your computer across the Internet, from server to server. These passes across the Internet are known as hops. The fewer the hops, the better the transfer speed. This is because there are fewer agents between the Web site and your PC. To calculate the number of hops between your PC and the site, you can use the 'tracert' command. To do this, go to the command prompt and type 'tracert' followed by the name of the Web site. You should see a screen such as the one shown below.

```
C:\>tracert download.com
Tracing route to download.com [206.16.0.148] over a maximum of 30 hops:
 1  1 ms  <10 ms  <10 ms  128.128.130.99
 2  6 ms   6 ms   7 ms  202.46.193.201
...
10 534 ms 467 ms 373 ms acr1-ae0.SanFrancisco.cw.net [206.24.211.33]
11 489 ms 461 ms 436 ms cw-gw.sfcca.ip.att.net [192.205.32.109]
12 444 ms 452 ms 442 ms tbr1-p012201.sfcca.ip.att.net [12.123.13.189]
...
17 410 ms 496 ms * download.com [206.16.0.148]
18 439 ms 421 ms 508 ms download.com [206.16.0.148]
Trace complete.
```

Don't get confused—all you have to do is look at the last number, which indicates the number of hops. In this case, the number of hops is 18, and that means the data passes through 18 locations before reaching the site. Use ping and hops as an indication to the best mirror to download your file. The best choice is a responsive server that is not far away in terms of hops.



FlashGet uses Multipoint Downloading which improves speed